



Meta Ads Playbook 2026

Benchmarks | Diagnosis | Optimisation

Find where your campaign is leaking,
and fix it in the right order.

INSIDE

- Part 1: Benchmarks (Global \$ and India ₹) + break-even math
- Part 2: 7-layer diagnosis, symptom tables, pattern reading
- Part 3: Structure, creative testing, scale / hold / kill rules
- Weekly routine + 30-day optimisation plan
- Lead-gen quality fixes for India
- Real case study: ₹1L budget campaign
- Templates: baseline sheet, test log, weekly review

Shoeb Akhtar

Performance Marketer | Trendedit Agency

How this playbook works

Three parts. One loop. Use it every week on every account.

Most Meta Ads advice tells you *what* to do. This playbook tells you **in what order**. Most wasted budget comes from fixing the wrong layer: changing the audience when the tracking is broken, or scaling before the offer works.

Part	Question it answers	You will get
1. Benchmarks	Is my number normal, and is it profitable?	Global and India ranges, objective-wise metrics, break-even math
2. Diagnosis	What exactly is broken?	A 7-layer diagnosis order, symptom tables, pattern reading, checklists
3. Optimisation	What do I change, and when do I scale?	Structure, creative testing, scale/hold/kill rules, weekly routine, 30-day plan

The loop

Benchmark (where am I?) → **Diagnose** (what is leaking?) → **Optimise** (change one thing) → **Measure** (wait for data) → repeat.

Four rules used throughout

- **Fix in order.** Upstream problems poison downstream numbers: Tracking → Delivery → Creative → Offer → Landing page → Audience → Budget.
- **Change one variable at a time.** Otherwise you will never know what worked.
- **Wait for enough data.** Judging an ad after ₹300 of spend is noise, not insight.
- **Log everything.** A test you did not write down is a test you will repeat.

About the numbers

Benchmarks vary by industry, audience, placement, country and funnel stage. Every threshold in this book (like “spend 2–3× target CPA before killing an ad”) is a **rule of thumb** from practice, not an official Meta rule. Adjust for your budget and volume.

PART

1

Benchmarks

Know what normal looks like, then know what profitable looks like.

1.1 Read benchmarks by funnel layer

Do not look at all metrics at once. Group them into three layers so each number points to one fix.

Layer	Metrics	Question it answers	Usually fixed by
Attention	CPM, CTR, hook rate, frequency	Do people notice and care?	Creative, hook, audience size
Interest	CPC, link clicks, landing page view rate	Do they click and actually arrive?	Ad-to-page match, page speed
Conversion	CVR, CPL / CPA, ROAS, lead quality	Do they act, and is it profitable?	Offer, landing page, follow-up

Hook rate ($3\text{-second video views} \div \text{impressions}$) and **hold rate** ($\text{ThruPlays or } 50\% \text{ views} \div 3\text{-second views}$) are useful custom metrics for video. There is no official benchmark, so track your own baseline and compare ads against each other.

1.2 Meta Ads benchmarks: Global (\$)

Metric	2026 Benchmark (Global)	Meaning / Notes
CTR (Link Click)	1.5% - 2.6%	% of people who clicked the link
CTR (All)	2.0% - 4.5%	% who clicked any part of the ad
CPC (Link Click)	\$0.70 - \$1.72	Avg. cost per link click
CPM (All)	\$6.80 - \$28.40	Cost per 1,000 impressions
CPL (Leads)	\$1.50 - \$12.00	Cost per lead (varies by industry)
CPA (Purchases)	\$10.00 - \$50.00	Cost per purchase (varies by industry)
ROAS (E-commerce)	1.9x - 3.0x+	Revenue $\div$ ad spend
Conversion Rate (Website)	1.5% - 3.0%	% of website visitors who converted
Conversion Rate (Lead Form)	8% - 20%	% who submitted the form
Add to Cart Rate	5% - 15%	% of visitors who added to cart
Initiate Checkout Rate	3% - 10%	% who started checkout
Purchase Conversion Rate	1% - 4%	% of visitors who purchased
Cost per Add to Cart	\$1.00 - \$7.00	Avg. cost per add to cart
Cost per Checkout Initiated	\$2.00 - \$10.00	Avg. cost per checkout initiated
Frequency	1.5 - 3.0	Avg. times an ad is seen per person
Impression Share	40% - 70%	% of available impressions received
Landing Page View Rate	70% - 90%	% of link clicks that load the landing page
Video View Rate (25% / 50%)	15-35% / 8-20%	% who watched 25% / 50% of the video
Video View Rate (75% / 100%)	5-15% / 3-10%	% who watched 75% / 100% of the video
Engagement Rate (Post)	3% - 8%	% who engaged with the post
Cost per Page Like	\$0.05 - \$0.30	Avg. cost per page like
Cost per Message (Leads)	\$1.00 - \$7.00	Avg. cost per message / conversation
Cost per ThruPlay (Video)	\$0.01 - \$0.05	Cost for a 15-second video view

1.3 Meta Ads benchmarks: India (₹)

Metric	Ideal Benchmark (India)	Meaning / Notes
CTR (Link Clicks)	0.80% - 1.80%	% of people who clicked the link
CTR (All)	1.20% - 2.50%	% who clicked any part of the ad
CPC (Link Clicks)	₹1.50 - ₹6.00	Avg. cost per link click
CPM (All)	₹60 - ₹180	Cost per 1,000 impressions
CPM (Link Clicks)	₹80 - ₹250	Cost per 1,000 link-click impressions
CPA (Leads)	₹120 - ₹450	Cost to get one lead
CPA (Purchases)	₹250 - ₹900	Cost to get one purchase
ROAS (E-commerce)	2.5x - 5x	Return on ad spend
Conversion Rate (All)	2.0% - 6.0%	% of visitors who took any conversion action
Conversion Rate (Website)	1.5% - 4.5%	% of website visitors who converted
Conversion Rate (App Installs)	10% - 25%	% of clicks that install the app
Frequency	1.5 - 3.0	Avg. times an ad is seen per person
Impression Share	40% - 70%	% of impression share vs total available
Landing Page View Rate	35% - 60%	% of clicks that view the landing page
Add to Cart Rate	8% - 20%	% of website visitors who add to cart
Cost per Add to Cart	₹50 - ₹200	Avg. cost per add to cart
Cost per View (Video)	₹0.20 - ₹1.20	Avg. cost per video view
Video View Rate (25% / 50%)	15-35% / 8-20%	% who watched 25% / 50% of the video
Video View Rate (75% / 100%)	5-15% / 3-10%	% who watched 75% / 100% of the video
Relevance / Quality	7/10+	Ad relevance (7 or higher is good)
Engagement Rate (Post)	3% - 10%	% of people who engaged with the post
Cost per Page Like	₹3 - ₹12	Avg. cost per page like
Cost per Message (Leads)	₹80 - ₹250	Avg. cost per message / lead
Budget Scaling	+20-30% every 5-7 days	Increase budget gradually for stable results

Tier 2 and Tier 3 audiences often have lower CPMs but also lower purchasing power, so compare CPL and CPA to your own break-even, not just to the range.

1.4 Which metric matters for which objective

Optimising a Leads campaign for CPM or a Sales campaign for likes is the most common metric mistake.

Objective	Primary metrics	Support metrics	Do not judge by
Leads (instant form)	CPL, cost per qualified lead, lead→sale rate	Form completion rate, frequency	CPM alone, likes
Leads (website)	CPL, landing page view rate, CVR	CTR, CPC, page speed	CTR alone
Sales (e-commerce)	CPA, ROAS, AOV	Add-to-cart rate, checkout rate, CPC	CTR, reach
Traffic	CPC, landing page view rate	Engaged sessions in GA4	Link clicks without arrival
Awareness / Reach	CPM, reach, frequency	ThruPlay cost, video view rate	CPA, ROAS
Messages	Cost per conversation, reply rate	Conversation→sale rate	Cost per click
Engagement	Engagement rate, cost per engagement	Page likes, saves, shares	Direct sales

1.5 Cold vs retargeting: expect different numbers

Metric	Cold prospecting	Retargeting (warm)
CPM	Usually lower	Usually higher (small, competitive audience)
CTR	Lower	Higher
CVR	Lower	Higher (often 2-5× cold)
CPA / ROAS	Worse on paper, but it fills the funnel	Better on paper, but it only harvests demand
Frequency	Keep near 1.5-3	Can run higher for short windows (3-7 days)

Never judge cold traffic by retargeting benchmarks. A blended average hides which side is working.

1.6 Break-even math: the benchmark that decides profit

A benchmark tells you what is **normal**. Break-even tells you what is **profitable**. Always calculate this first.

Business	Formula	Example
E-commerce: break-even CPA	$\text{AOV} \times \text{gross margin}$	$\text{AOV ₹1,500} \times 40\% = \text{₹600}$
E-commerce: break-even ROAS	$1 \div \text{gross margin}$	$1 \div 0.40 = 2.5\text{x}$
Lead gen: max CPL	$\text{Lead} \rightarrow \text{customer rate} \times (\text{customer value} \times \text{margin})$	$5\% \times (\text{₹20,000} \times 60\%) = \text{₹600}$
Lead gen: target CPL	$\text{Max CPL} \times 0.6 \text{ to } 0.7 \text{ (leave room for profit)}$	$\text{₹600} \times 0.65 \approx \text{₹390}$

How to use it

If your CPA is ₹500 and break-even is ₹600, you are “profitable” but with almost no room to scale. If your CPA is ₹350, you can spend more. Compare your real CPA to **your** break-even before you compare it to any benchmark.

1.7 Your baseline sheet

Fill this from your last 30 days before you change anything. This is the sheet you will compare against after every optimisation.

Metric	My last 30 days	Benchmark range	My target	Status
Spend				
CPM				
CTR (link)				
CPC (link)				
Landing page view rate				
CVR				
CPL / CPA				
ROAS				
Frequency (cold)				
Qualified lead %				
Break-even CPA / CPL				

PART
2

Diagnosis

Find the real problem before you touch a single setting.

2.1 The 7-layer diagnosis order

Always start at layer 1. If a layer is broken, every layer below it gives you misleading data.

#	Layer	Ask	Broken looks like
1	Tracking	Is Meta seeing the conversions that really happen?	Numbers in Meta, GA4 and CRM disagree wildly
2	Delivery	Is the ad set getting enough data to optimise?	Learning limited, underspending, unstable CPA
3	Creative	Does the ad stop the scroll and earn the click?	Low CTR, high CPM, rising frequency
4	Offer	Is what you sell worth the click?	Good CTR, no conversions, comments about price
5	Landing page	Does the page keep the promise of the ad?	Clicks arrive but leave; low CVR
6	Audience / structure	Is the right person seeing it, without overlap?	High CPM, ad sets competing, junk leads
7	Budget	Is spend right for the data and the goal?	Too low to learn, or scaled too fast

2.2 Layer 1: tracking audit

- ☐ Meta Pixel fires on all key pages, and standard events (ViewContent, AddToCart, InitiateCheckout, Purchase or Lead) fire **once** each.
- ☐ Conversions API is connected **and** deduplicated with the Pixel (matching event_id).
- ☐ Event match quality reviewed in Events Manager; customer parameters (email, phone) passed where allowed.
- ☐ Domain verified and the priority conversion events are configured.
- ☐ Purchase events pass **value** and currency.
- ☐ All ads use UTM parameters (source, medium, campaign, content) so GA4 can be compared with Meta.
- ☐ Test Events tool used after every site change (theme update, checkout change, new plugin).
- ☐ Meta-reported conversions compared with GA4 / Shopify / CRM weekly.

*A gap between Meta and your own system is normal because of attribution windows and privacy limits. A **large or growing** gap is the flag. For lead gen, the only number that really counts is what your CRM says became a sale.*

2.3 Layer 2: delivery diagnosis

Signal	What it means	Fix
Learning phase	Ad set is still gathering data (roughly 50 optimisation events in 7 days to exit).	Do not edit. Let it run. Avoid big budget or audience changes.
Learning limited	Not enough events to exit learning.	Consolidate ad sets, raise budget, or optimise for a higher-volume event.
Underspending	Audience too narrow, bid or cost cap too low, or weak ad.	Widen audience, relax the cap, add stronger creative.
One ad takes all spend	Normal. The algorithm found its favourite.	Add new creatives instead of pausing the winner.
Ads in review / limited	Policy or account-quality issue.	Fix the policy issue, check Account Quality, appeal if needed.

Minimum budget formula

Weekly budget $\approx$ **target CPA** $\times$ 50. Daily $\approx$ that $\div$ 7.

Example: target CPA ₹300 $\rightarrow$ ₹15,000 per week $\rightarrow$ about **₹2,140 per day** per ad set. If you cannot afford that, optimise for a higher-volume event (Lead instead of Purchase, or Add to Cart) and run fewer ad sets.

2.4 Layer 3: creative diagnosis

Split the creative into three jobs and measure each one.

Job	Signal to check	If weak, the problem is
Stop the scroll	Hook rate (3-second views $\div$ impressions), CTR, CPM	The first 2–3 seconds or the first frame
Keep attention	Hold rate, 50% and 75% video views	The body: too slow, too long, no payoff
Earn the click	Link CTR, CPC, landing page view rate	The offer, the CTA, or a mismatch with the page

Creative fatigue: the 5 signs

- Frequency above $\sim$ 3 in cold audiences.
- CTR down 20–30% versus the first week.
- CPM rising while CTR falls.
- CPA worsening 3+ days in a row with no other change.
- Comments like “I keep seeing this ad”, or engagement dropping.

2.5 Metric-by-metric diagnosis

Symptom	Likely causes	How to confirm	Fix
High CPM	Small or over-competitive audience; audience overlap; low ad quality; peak season; fatigue.	Compare CPM by placement and audience; check overlap tool; check frequency.	Broaden audience, merge overlapping ad sets, refresh creative, test Reels placements.
Low CTR (link)	Weak hook; generic visual; wrong audience; no clear promise.	Compare CTR across ads. If all are low, it is offer or audience. If one is low, it is that creative.	New hooks in first 2 seconds, clearer promise, stronger CTA, test new angles.
High CPC	Low CTR; competitive audience; poor relevance; wrong placement.	$CPC = CPM \div (CTR \times 10)$. A high CPC is almost always a CTR or CPM problem.	Fix CTR first. Then broaden audience or exclude poor placements.
Low landing page view rate (large gap between clicks and page views)	Slow page; accidental clicks; broken redirects; heavy pages on mobile.	Link clicks vs landing page views; PageSpeed Insights; test on a 4G phone.	Compress images, remove heavy scripts, use a lighter page, fix redirects.
Low CVR	Ad promise $\neq$ page; weak offer; long or confusing form; no trust; not mobile-friendly.	Session recordings; funnel drop-off in GA4; compare CVR by device.	Match headline to ad, cut form fields, add proof, add a WhatsApp or call option.
High CPA / CPL	Any of the above; audience too broad or too narrow; low-quality traffic.	Use the funnel: CTR $\rightarrow$ CPC $\rightarrow$ landing page view $\rightarrow$ CVR. Find the weak layer.	Fix the weakest layer only. Do not change audience, creative and page together.
Low ROAS	Low AOV; weak offer; high CPA; heavy discounting; returns; attribution overlap.	Compare ROAS with break-even ROAS; check blended MER (total revenue $\div$ total ad spend).	Raise AOV (bundles, upsell), fix offer, improve checkout, test new creatives.
High frequency	Audience too small; budget too high for the audience; one creative running too long.	Frequency by ad set; reach vs impressions trend.	Expand audience, add creatives, lower budget or exclude past engagers.
Low lead quality	Easy instant form; broad audience; weak qualifying; slow follow-up.	Track lead $\rightarrow$ qualified $\rightarrow$ sale by ad set and creative.	Add qualifying questions, use higher-intent forms, follow up fast (see 2.7).

2.6 Pattern reading: combinations tell the real story

Pattern	Diagnosis	Action
High CTR + low CVR	Message mismatch, weak landing page, curiosity clicks, or a weak offer.	Match headline to ad, tighten the promise, fix the page.
Low CTR + low CPM	Cheap, low-intent audience; boring creative.	Sharpen the hook and the audience.
High CPM + high CTR + high CPA	Good ad, competitive audience, leak after the click.	Fix landing page and offer before touching the ad.
Good CPL but poor sales	Lead quality problem: easy form, wrong audience, slow follow-up.	Optimise for qualified leads, not cheap leads.
Good ROAS in Meta but flat revenue	Attribution overlap or view-through credit.	Check blended MER and compare with GA4.
CPA good at first, worse later	Fatigue or audience saturation.	Add new creatives, expand audience.
One ad set great, the rest zero spend	Budget concentrated where the algorithm sees signal.	Consolidate or test new creatives in the winning ad set.
Retargeting ROAS huge, cold ROAS poor	Retargeting is harvesting demand cold traffic created.	Judge both together; keep cold budget healthy.

2.7 Lead-gen quality diagnosis (India)

- **Measure the whole chain:** lead → contacted → qualified → sale, by ad set and by creative. A ₹100 lead that never picks up is worse than a ₹300 lead that buys.
- **Instant form vs website:** instant forms give more, cheaper, lower-intent leads. Use “higher intent” forms with a review step or add 1–2 qualifying questions.
- **Speed to lead:** call or WhatsApp within minutes, not hours. Slow follow-up is often blamed on the ads.
- **Close the loop:** send lead stages from your CRM back to Meta through Conversions API so delivery learns what a good lead looks like.
- **Language and region:** in Tier 2 and Tier 3 cities, regional-language creatives often qualify better than English ones.

2.8 Ad account health check

Score each line: 0 = broken, 1 = partly, 2 = good. Total out of 20.

#	Check	Score (0/1/2)
1	Pixel + Conversions API firing and deduplicated	
2	Meta numbers reconcile with GA4 / CRM within a reasonable gap	
3	Ad sets exit learning (or are close)	
4	3+ distinct creative angles running in cold audiences	
5	Frequency under control in cold audiences	
6	Landing page loads fast on mobile and matches the ad	
7	Break-even CPA / ROAS is known and written down	
8	Lead quality is tracked to sale (or purchase value is tracked)	
9	Winners and losers are reviewed weekly	
10	A test log exists and is updated	

Reading your score

0-8: fix tracking and basics before any optimisation. **9-14:** the system works, optimise creative and offer. **15-20:** you are ready to scale carefully.

PART
3

Optimisation

Change the right thing, in the right order, and scale only what works.

3.1 The optimisation priority order

1. Tracking → 2. Creative → 3. Offer → 4. Landing page → 5. Audience → 6. Budget scaling

Golden rule

Don't blame the audience first. Fix the **creative**, **offer** and **landing page** before touching targeting. The biggest gains rarely come from one hack. They come from optimising the whole system consistently.

3.2 Account structure: keep it simple

Meta's delivery is now AI-driven, so fewer campaigns and ad sets give each one more data, and creative variety does more of the “targeting”.

Campaign	Audience	Ad sets	Creatives	Budget share
Prospecting (cold)	Broad or Advantage+ audience; optional interests / lookalikes as tests	1-3	3-6 per ad set, different angles	~60-70%
Retargeting (warm)	Site visitors 30d, engaged viewers, add-to-cart 7d, lead-form openers	1-2	Proof, offer, urgency, objections	~20-30%
Existing customers (optional)	Buyers, past leads (upsell, referral)	1	Upsell, loyalty, referral	~5-10%

*Simple budget split inside winners: **60%** scale winners, **30%** test new, **10%** let losers run out briefly, then kill.*

3.3 Creative optimisation

Five angles to rotate

Angle	Idea	Example (marketing niche)
Problem	Name the pain the viewer already feels	"Your ads have a good CTR and still lose money."
Solution	Show the way out	"This 7-step diagnosis finds the leak in 20 minutes."
Proof	Numbers, before / after, testimonials	"CPL ₹150 → ₹100 in 30 days."
Offer	Make the deal clear and specific	"Free audit sheet with 26 benchmarks."
Objection	Answer the doubt before they voice it	"No big budget needed. Works from ₹500 a day."

Five hook formulas for the first 2 seconds

Hook type	Formula	Example
Consequence	"If you ignore X, Y happens"	"Ignore frequency and your CPA doubles by week 3."
Number	Specific result + timeframe	"How we cut CPL by 33% in 30 days."
Question	A question the buyer asks themselves	"Why is my CTR fine but nobody buys?"
Contrarian	Challenge a common belief	"Don't blame your audience. Blame your landing page."
Before / After	Show the gap	"This ad: ₹450 CPL. This one: ₹110 CPL."

Creative testing framework

- Test **3 angles × 2 formats** (video / Reels 9:16 and static or carousel) in one prospecting ad set.
- To test hooks, keep the body of the video the same and change only the first 2–3 seconds.
- Name every ad: **Angle_Format_Hook#_Date** (example: Proof_Reel_H2_0929). You will thank yourself in a month.
- Judge after the ad has spent roughly **2–3× target CPA** (or has enough impressions for hook metrics). Not before.
- Refresh cold creatives every 2–4 weeks depending on spend and frequency. Keep winners running and add variations of them.

Creative brief template

Field	Fill in
Audience + awareness stage	
Angle	
Hook (first 2 seconds)	
Body (proof / demo)	
CTA	
Format + length	
Success metric	

3.4 Audience optimisation

Audience type	Use when	Risk / note
Broad (no interests)	Strong creative, enough budget and conversion history	Needs good tracking; weak creative gets expensive fast
Advantage+ audience	You want Meta to expand beyond your suggestions	Give strong signals: good creatives and clean conversion data
Interests / behaviours	New account with little data, or a narrow niche	Overlap between ad sets raises CPM
Lookalike (1-5%)	You have 1,000+ quality customer records	Seed quality matters more than size
Retargeting	Always, but keep it a small share of budget	Only harvests demand; shrinks if cold stops

Retargeting windows by intent

Audience	Window	Message
Cart / checkout / form openers	1-7 days	Urgency, remove the last objection, offer help
Product / landing page viewers	7-14 days	Proof, testimonials, comparison
Video viewers (50%+), engagers	14-30 days	Case study, offer, invitation
Past customers	30-180 days	Upsell, referral, new product

Always exclude: recent purchasers or leads from prospecting, and prospecting audiences from retargeting, so you do not pay to reach the same person twice.

3.5 Offer and landing page optimisation

☐	The headline repeats the promise of the ad (message match).
☐	One goal, one main CTA. No menu that leaks visitors.
☐	Loads in under ~3 seconds on a mobile network; images compressed.
☐	Proof above the fold: numbers, logos, testimonials, ratings.
☐	Form asks only what you need (aim for 3-5 fields); phone field validated.
☐	WhatsApp or click-to-call button for India, where many buyers prefer to chat first.
☐	Price, timeline and next step are clear. Urgency is real, not fake.
☐	Thank-you page fires the conversion event and tells the user what happens next.

3.6 Bidding and budget

Strategy	Use when	Watch out
Highest volume (lowest cost)	Default. Best for learning and volume.	CPA can swing; needs steady creative.
Cost per result goal	You have a stable CPA and want to hold it.	Set too low and delivery stops.
Bid cap	You need strict control on cost per auction.	Often underspends; use carefully.
ROAS goal	E-commerce with purchase values and volume.	Needs enough purchases; set realistic goals.

Rules for edits

- Do not edit ad sets during the learning phase unless something is clearly broken.
- Increase budget by **20-30% every 5-7 days**, not 100% overnight. Large jumps can reset learning and spike CPA.
- Prefer **adding** new ads over editing live ones. Editing an ad resets its history.

3.7 Scale / Hold / Fix / Kill rules

Use your **target CPA** (from break-even, section 1.6) as the ruler. Judge over 3-5 days with enough conversions to trust the number (roughly 10+).

Decision	When (CPA vs target)	Action
Scale	CPA at or below ~80% of target, stable 3-5 days	Raise budget 20-30% every 5-7 days, or duplicate into a new ad set. Add variations of the winning creative.
Hold	CPA about 80-120% of target	Leave the budget. Test one new creative inside the ad set.
Fix	CPA about 120-150% of target	Change one variable: creative or landing page first, audience last.
Kill	CPA above ~150% after spending 2-3x target CPA, no improving trend	Pause. Log why. Reallocate budget to winners.

Three ways to scale

- **Vertical:** raise the budget on the winning ad set.
- **Horizontal:** new audiences, placements, geographies, or a duplicate of the winner.
- **Creative:** new hooks and formats built from what already works. This is the scaling lever that lasts longest.

3.8 The weekly and monthly routine

When	Task	Time
Daily	Check spend pacing, disapproved ads, sudden CPM or CPA spikes. Do not optimise on daily noise.	5 min
Twice a week	Check lead quality or sales from CRM / Shopify. Reply to ad comments.	15 min
Weekly	Review by ad: frequency, CTR, CPA vs target. Scale / Hold / Fix / Kill. Add 2-3 new creatives. Update the test log.	45 min
Monthly	Tracking audit (section 2.2), structure clean-up, refresh benchmarks and break-even, plan next month's tests.	2 hours

3.9 The 30-day optimisation plan

Week	Focus	Deliverables
1	Tracking + baseline	Tracking audit done, baseline sheet filled, break-even CPA known, health score calculated
2	Creative round 1	3 angles × 2 formats live, naming convention set, first Scale / Hold / Fix / Kill review
3	Offer + landing page	Message match fixed, form shortened, page speed improved, round 2 of creative tests
4	Scale + retargeting	Winners scaled 20-30%, retargeting campaign live, next month's test plan written

3.10 Case study: ₹1,00,000 lead-gen campaign (education, India)

Approximate figures: 30 days, Meta Ads, Tier 2 and Tier 3 students. 3,50,000 impressions, 10,500 clicks (CTR 3.0%, CPC ₹9.52), 1,000 leads, landing page CVR 9.5%, about 600 qualified, about 50-60 admissions, revenue about ₹7,50,000 (ROAS 7.5x, ROI 650%).

What changed	Which layer	Playbook section
Monitored audience-wise CPL, CTR and lead quality	Diagnosis (pattern reading)	2.6, 2.7
Shifted budget to high-performing ad sets, paused high-CPL ones	Budget / Scale-Kill rules	3.7
Tested multiple creatives and angles (A/B)	Creative	3.3
Shortened and improved the lead form	Landing page / offer	3.5
Retargeted interested users	Audience / funnel	3.4
Day-wise budget optimisation	Budget	3.6, 3.8

Result

CPL fell from about ₹150 to about ₹100 while CTR stayed near 3%. None of the wins came from one hack. They came from working the layers in order.

3.11 Templates

Test log

Date	Hypothesis	Variable changed	Budget / days	Result (CTR, CPA)	Decision

Weekly review

Ad / ad set	Spend	Freq.	CTR	CPA / CPL	vs target	Scale / Hold / Fix / Kill

Good ads get clicks. Great systems get customers.

Optimisation turns both into profit. Test hard. Learn fast. Scale smart.

About the author

Shoeb Akhtar runs Google Ads, Meta Ads and LinkedIn Ads for clients across India, the US, UK, Dubai and Europe, with a focus on tracking, AI automation and analytics. Portfolio: trendeditagency.my.canva.site/shoeb-akhtar

Disclaimer: Benchmarks and thresholds are directional rules of thumb compiled for education. They are not guarantees or official platform averages. Results depend on industry, offer, creative, audience, tracking quality and budget.